Manel Leiva

Senior Product Designer, Design Systems

maneleiva@gmail.com | +34 622 144 909 | https://manel-leiva.com | https://linkedin.com/in/maneleiva

SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 15 years designing digital products, with recent work focused on complex financial software and design systems.

Helped build and maintain Abacum's design system across five product squads, then built and ran Remuner's system as sole designer.

Works directly with engineers on component states and behaviors, Figma libraries, tokens, documentation, and the pipelines connecting design to production.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Built the Figma component library and design system from scratch as sole designer, alongside product work across the full product surface.
- Ran an ongoing product audit: captured existing patterns, defined and documented component variants, states, and behaviors, then worked with engineers to decide when each improvement should ship.
- Owned the design side of the token pipeline; used Codex to add CI validation, drift detection, smoke tests, W3C token output, an HTML preview, and JSON output through engineering-reviewed PRs.
- Ran a monthly governance meeting with engineering to review progress, resolve implementation issues, and keep the system aligned with product priorities.
- Adapted the responsive web product for mobile and shipped it as live iOS and Android webview apps.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Built the Abax design system alongside product work: Figma variables, a two-tier token architecture, component library, governance, and a Token Studio to Style Dictionary pipeline used across five squads.
- Co-led the design-system business case with the head of design and presented it to engineering leadership; the work was selected for dedicated design and engineering time.
- Ran the weekly design-library sync and structured contribution process; components moved from exploration to the canonical implementation library only after review.
- Created contribution guidelines, naming and deprecation conventions, issue-reporting categories, and the release and migration process for existing product surfaces.

Senior Product Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Co-founded and led a UX studio for 11 years; designed products for media, retail, finance, legal, and culture clients.
- Built much of what I designed, including CMS-connected WordPress themes, front-end component libraries, and a shared starter kit with a build pipeline and CSS variables.
- Taught UX and digital design at postgraduate level, including taking a design file through to a working CMS-driven site.

SKILLS

Design systems: Component architecture, Figma libraries and variables, design tokens, documentation, governance, contribution models, migration planning
Interaction and visual design: Component states and behaviors, responsive interfaces, complex workflows, product architecture
Tools: Figma, Token Studio, Style Dictionary, Storybook, Chromatic, GitHub
Prototyping and implementation: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, MUI, Vuetify, Sass, Figma Make, Codex, AI-assisted coding
Collaboration: Engineering alignment, design critique, cross-functional facilitation, distributed teams

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002